Software Project Planning Guide

A practical framework for planning, scoping and launching your next software product.

Inside: goals, scope, budgeting, team, timeline, risk and launch checklists.

Sample guide shipped with the project - replace with the final branded PDF.

1. Define Goals & Success Metrics

- What business problem are we solving?
- Who are the primary users?
- Which 3 metrics define success (revenue, leads, retention)?
- What is the deadline and why?

2. Scope & Prioritise

- List features; tag Must / Should / Could.
- Define the smallest valuable first release (MVP).
- Document integrations, content and compliance needs.
- Agree what is explicitly out of scope.

3. Budget, Team & Timeline

- Estimate by phase: discovery, design, build, QA, launch.
- Assign a decision-maker and a day-to-day owner.
- Add 15-20% contingency.
- Plan weekly demos and a clear approval process.

4. Launch & Grow

- QA on real devices, accessibility and performance checks.
- Analytics, SEO and monitoring configured before go-live.
- Post-launch roadmap: measure, learn, iterate.

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